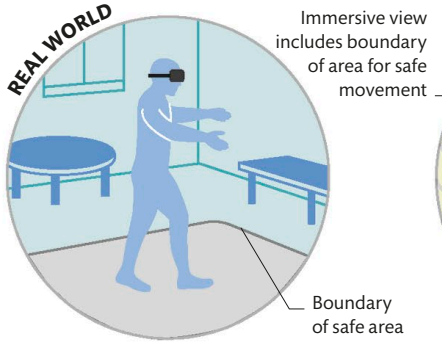
AUGMENTED REALITY

A technology closely associated with VR is augmented reality. Typically used on a smartphone or tablet, an augmented reality app adds virtual objects into the live view from the device's camera. In this way, virtual objects appear in the real world. This can be useful in adventure games or in displaying information about buildings or vehicles in the real world.



Virtual worlds

The scenes that can be explored inside a VR headset are stored inside a computer. Most virtual worlds are created using computer-generated imagery (CGI) with three-dimensional modeling software that creates digital representations of the virtual objects and surfaces. The scene exists as a sphere, with the viewer at the center and objects all around. The VR headset displays only the part of the sphere at which the viewer is looking.

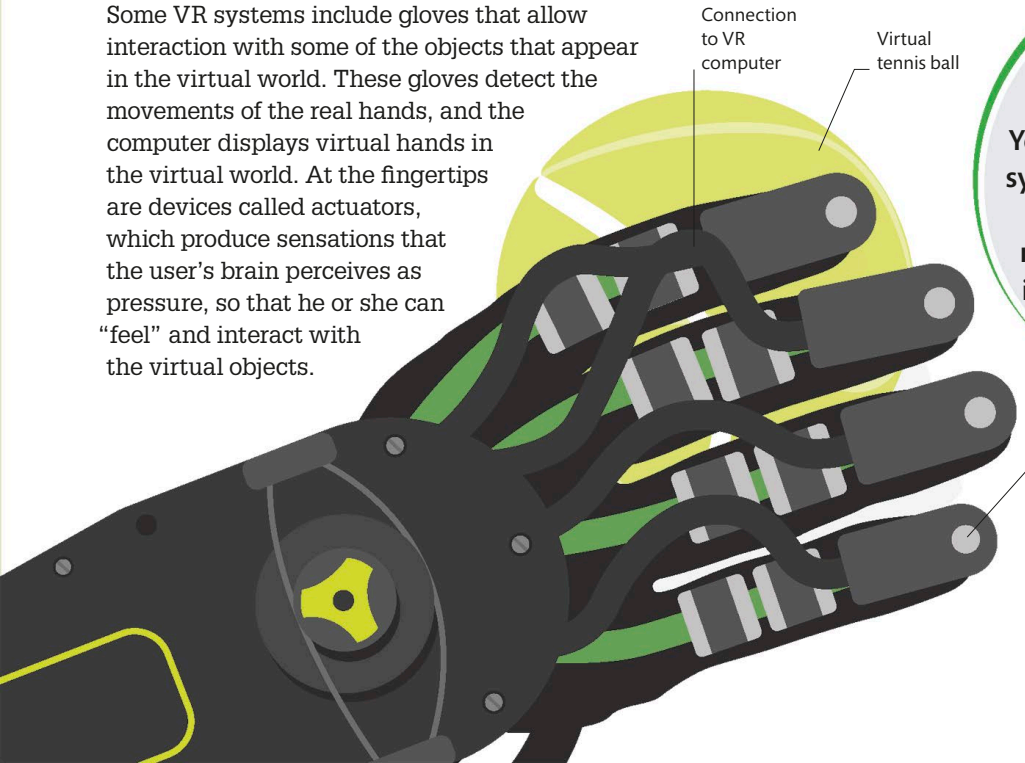


Real-world space
The real-world location can be anywhere—in a room, in a field, or on the beach. A VR headset blocks out the sights, and often the sounds, of the real world.

Immersive view
The screens inside the headset display a scene from a virtual world, and stereo headphones play virtual sounds, so that users feel as if they are really there.

Touch and feel

Some VR systems include gloves that allow interaction with some of the objects that appear in the virtual world. These gloves detect the movements of the real hands, and the computer displays virtual hands in the virtual world. At the fingertips are devices called actuators, which produce sensations that the user's brain perceives as pressure, so that he or she can "feel" and interact with the virtual objects.



VR glove
These gloves allow the user to feel the physical properties of objects in a virtual world, such as weight and shape. Motion trackers in the fingers help the user's hands to be accurately represented in the virtual world.

WILL I FEEL SICK IF I USE A VR HEADSET?

Yes. VR headsets can produce symptoms of motion sickness, even if your body is not moving, because your brain interprets movement in the virtual world.